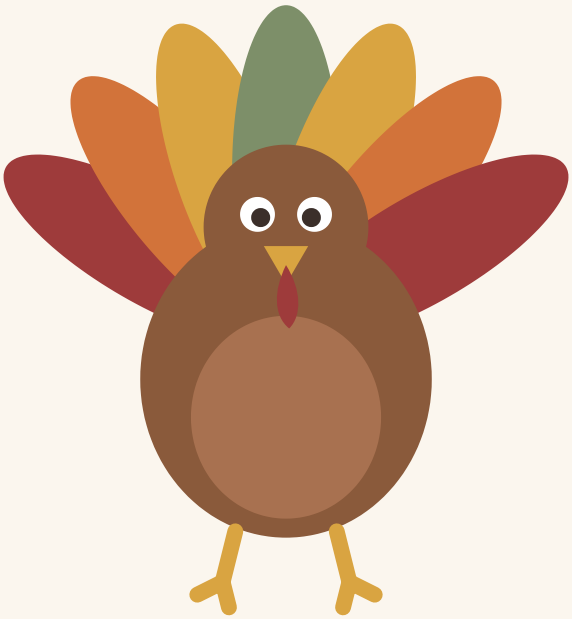


PRINTABLE ESCAPE ROOM FOR KIDS · AGES 7–12

Turkey Trouble

Escape Room

Gus the turkey has locked the pantry. Can you crack his 8 puzzles before dinner?

8 puzzles | 45–60 minutes | 1–8 players | Host guide + answer key

Host guide

READ BEFORE THE PARTY

The story

Gus the turkey would very much prefer that Thanksgiving dinner is *pie*, not turkey. So he has locked the pantry with an 8-letter code and hidden the clues all over the house. The players solve 8 puzzles. Each one reveals one letter of the code. When they have all 8 letters, they say the code word to you, and the pantry (and the pie) is theirs.

Who it's for

Kids 7–12, alone or in teams of 2–4. Younger kids do great with an older helper. Plan on 45–60 minutes.

What you need

- This file, printed (pages 4–16; one copy per team)
- 9 envelopes (or folders), and tape
- Pencils, scissors for the host
- A small treat or the real pie to "unlock" at the end
- Optional: a timer, and a box or bag that closes, as the "pantry"

Printing

Print at "Actual size". Color is best (puzzle 2 uses colored leaves), but black and white works for everything else.

Set-up (15 minutes).

1. Cut out the envelope labels (page 15) and stick one on each envelope.
2. Put each puzzle page (pages 6–13) in the envelope with its number. Put the Pantry Lock sheet (page 5) in the START envelope.
3. Hide envelopes 1–8 around the room or house. Keep the START envelope and the story card in your hand.
4. Cut out the hint cards (page 14) and keep them in your pocket.
5. Put the treat in the "pantry" and keep the FINALE half of the story card with it.

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Host guide

How to play

1. Gather the players and read Gus's letter aloud (page 4, top half).
2. Hand over the START envelope and say "Go!" Start the timer if you like.
3. Players search for envelopes and solve the puzzles in any order. Each puzzle tells them which letter of the code they found (letter 1, letter 2…).
4. They write each letter in its box on the Pantry Lock sheet.
5. When all 8 boxes are filled, they read the code word to you. If it's right, they open the pantry and you read the FINALE.

Hints

Every puzzle has a hint card. A good rule: a team can ask for a hint after trying a puzzle for 5 minutes, or trade a hint for a silly task (gobble like a turkey, name 5 pies).

Making it easier

- Don't hide the envelopes; lay them on the table.
- Tell younger players the code is a word that means "thankful".
- Solve puzzles 2 and 7 together, out loud.

Making it harder

- Set a 30-minute timer.
- Hide envelopes inside each other: envelope 5 is only found after solving 4, and so on.
- No hint cards.

Answers are on page 16. Keep that page (and the hint cards) away from the players. Each puzzle can also be checked on its own: the letter goes in the box at the bottom of the puzzle page.

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Story cards

HOST READS ALOUD · CUT IN HALF

READ FIRST

Dear Thanksgiving guests,

It's me, Gus. Yes, *that* turkey. I have heard some very worrying talk about "dinner", so I have locked the pantry with my secret 8-letter code. Nobody gets dessert until you crack it!

I have hidden 8 puzzles. Each one gives you one letter of the code. Solve them in any order, write each letter on the Pantry Lock sheet, and say the word out loud. If you're clever enough, maybe I'll share the pie.

Gobble gobble (good luck),
Gus

READ AT THE END

You did it! The code was **GRATEFUL**, and that is exactly what I am: grateful you cracked it, grateful for all of you, and very grateful that this year we're having pie.

The pantry is open. Please enjoy your treat, and save me a seat at the table. I'll be the one with the feathers.

Your friend,
Gus

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The Pantry Lock

START HERE

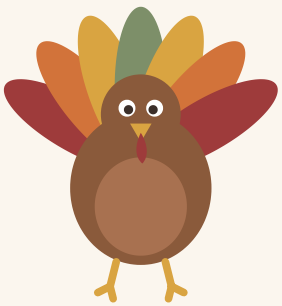
Gus has locked the pantry with an 8-letter code. Find the 8 envelopes, solve each puzzle and write its letter in the matching box.

LETTER 1	LETTER 2	LETTER 3	LETTER 4	LETTER 5	LETTER 6	LETTER 7	LETTER 8

When every box is full, read the word out loud to your host.

Puzzle checklist

- [ ] 1 · Pie Math
- [ ] 2 · Gus's Secret Code
- [ ] 3 · The Corn Maze
- [ ] 4 · Mixed-Up Kitchen
- [ ] 5 · Harvest Grid
- [ ] 6 · Spot the Difference
- [ ] 7 · Who Brought the Pie?
- [ ] 8 · What Comes Next?



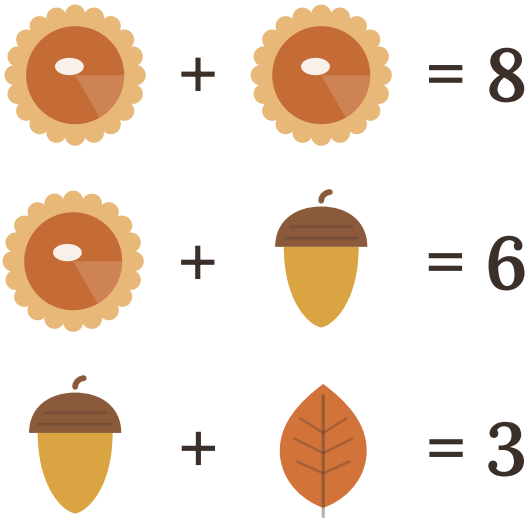
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1

PUZZLE 1 OF 8 · NUMBERS

Pie Math

Gus counts everything in pies. Each picture stands for a number. Work out what each one is worth.





TURKEY NUMBER CODE

A 1	**B** 2	**C** 3	**D** 4	**E** 5	**F** 6	**G** 7	**H** 8	**I** 9	**J** 10	**K** 11	**L** 12	**M** 13
N 14	**O** 15	**P** 16	**Q** 17	**R** 18	**S** 19	**T** 20	**U** 21	**V** 22	**W** 23	**X** 24	**Y** 25	**Z** 26

Find your answer in the Turkey number code. The letter above it is your letter.

Letter 1 of the pantry code. Write it in box 1 on the Pantry Lock.

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PUZZLE 2 OF 8 · CODES

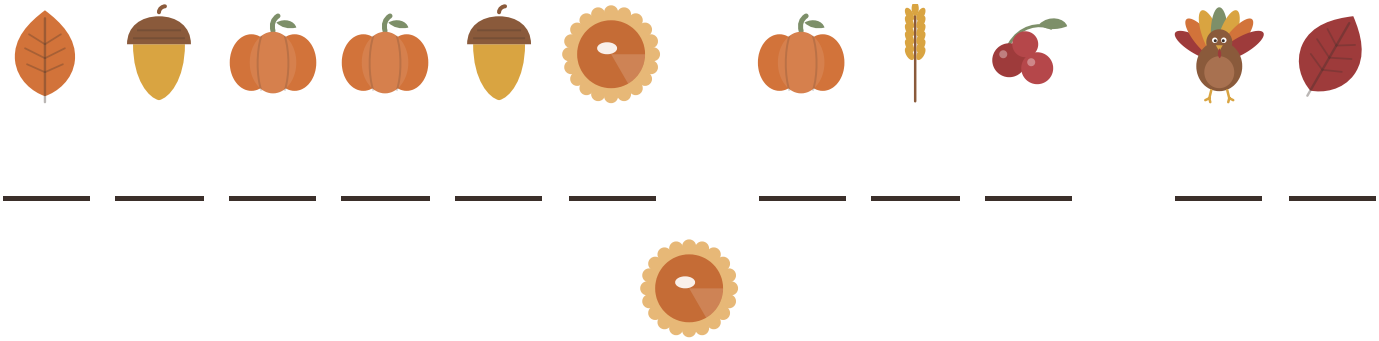
2 Gus's Secret Code

Gus wrote a note in his secret picture code. Use the code key to turn each picture into a letter.

Code key

 A	 E	 I	 L	 N
 O	 R	 S	 T	 W

Gus's note



Look closely: the four leaves are different colors.

Letter 2 of the pantry code. The note tells you which letter it is. Write it in box 2.

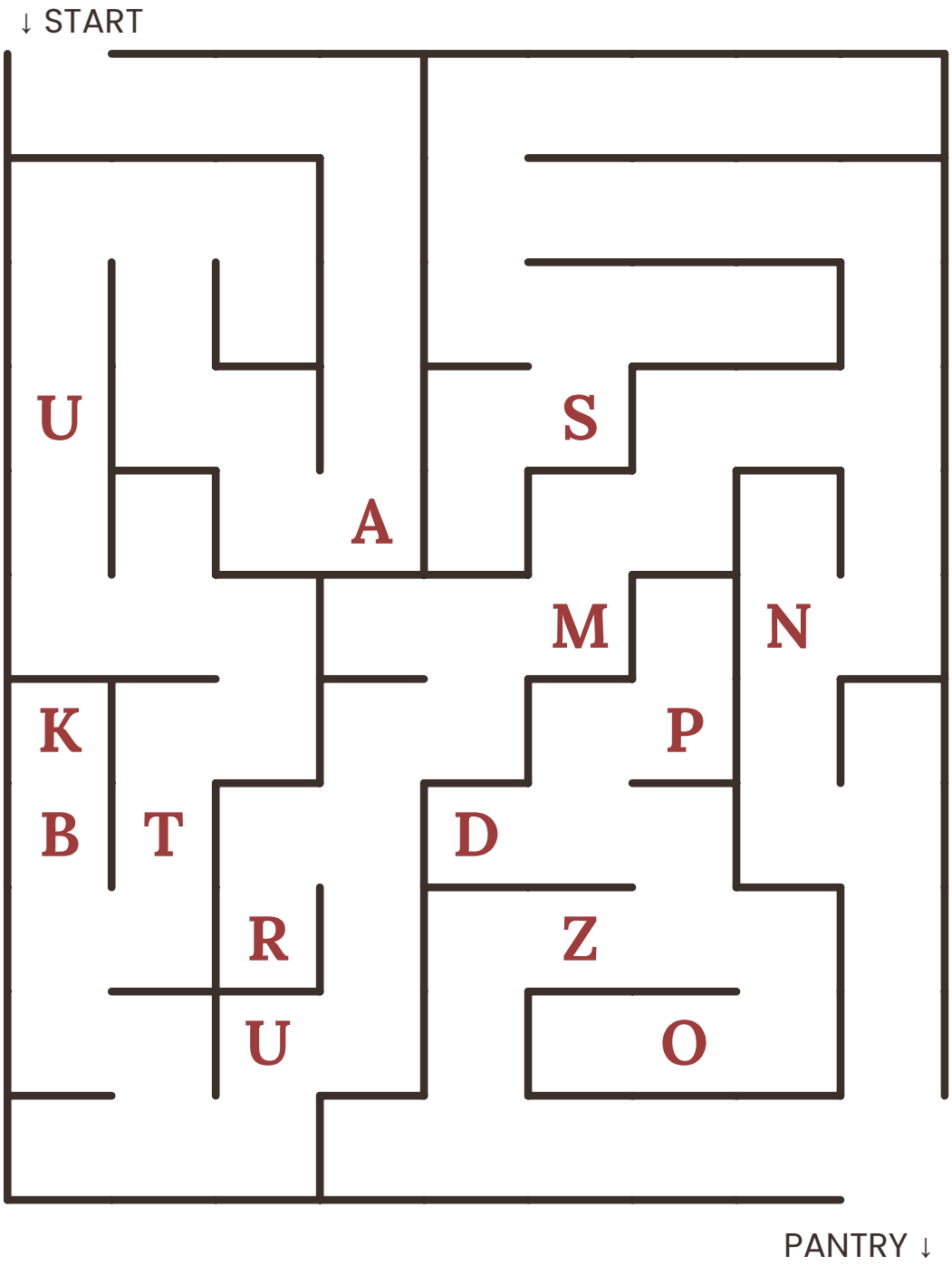
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3

PUZZLE 3 OF 8 · PATHS

The Corn Maze

Gus ran through the corn maze to the pantry. Follow the only path from START to PANTRY. Collect the letters you pass, in order. (The letters off the path are corn-fusing decoys!)



Letters I collected: _____

Letter 3 of the pantry code. It's the **first** letter of the word you collected. Write it in box 3.

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4

PUZZLE 4 OF 8 · WORDS

Mixed-Up Kitchen

Gus scrambled the words on the kitchen labels. Unscramble each one and write it in the boxes. The clue will help.

YRKTEU

He is hiding from dinner!

□ □ □ □ □ □

NEVO

Where the pie bakes

□ □ □ □

CRONA

A squirrel's favorite snack

□ □ □ □ □

FUSGNIFT

Bread and herbs, in or beside the bird

□ □ □ □ □ □ □ □

SKNAHT

What we give on the fourth Thursday

□ □ □ □ □ □

Now read the **shaded** boxes from top to bottom. They spell something you can make from bread (and say at the dinner table!): _____

□ **Letter 4 of the pantry code.** It's the first (and last) letter of that word. Write it in box 4.

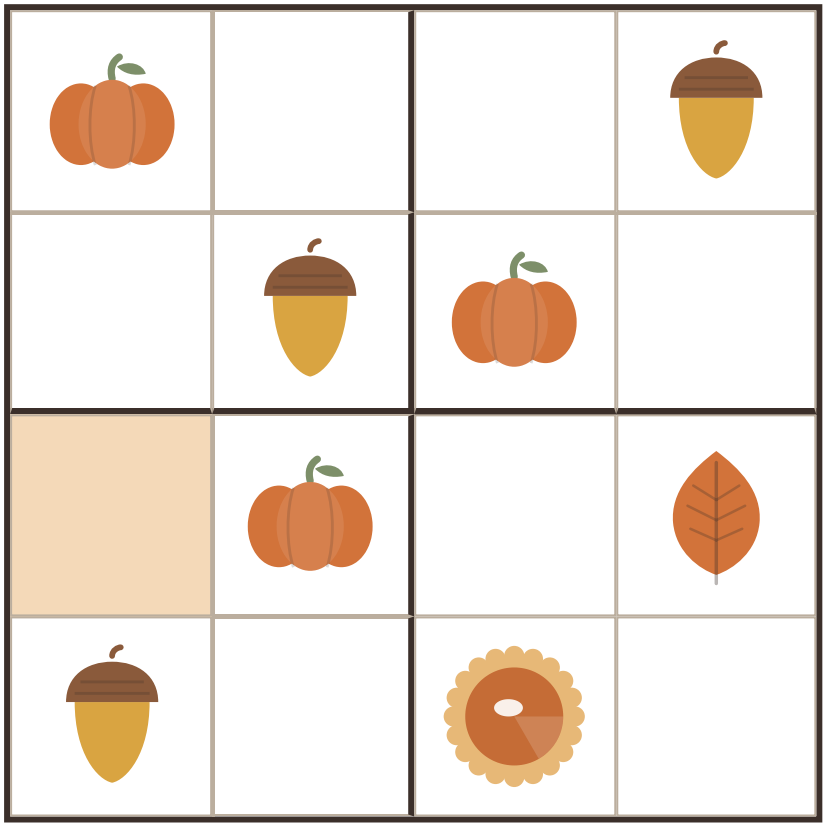
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PUZZLE 5 OF 8 · LOGIC

5 Harvest Grid

Gus planted his garden in a very particular way. Every row, every column and every 2×2 box must have one pumpkin, one pie, one leaf and one acorn.

Draw the missing pictures (a quick sketch is fine). Which picture goes in the **shaded** square?



Each picture is a letter:



Letter 5 of the pantry code. The shaded square's letter goes in box 5.

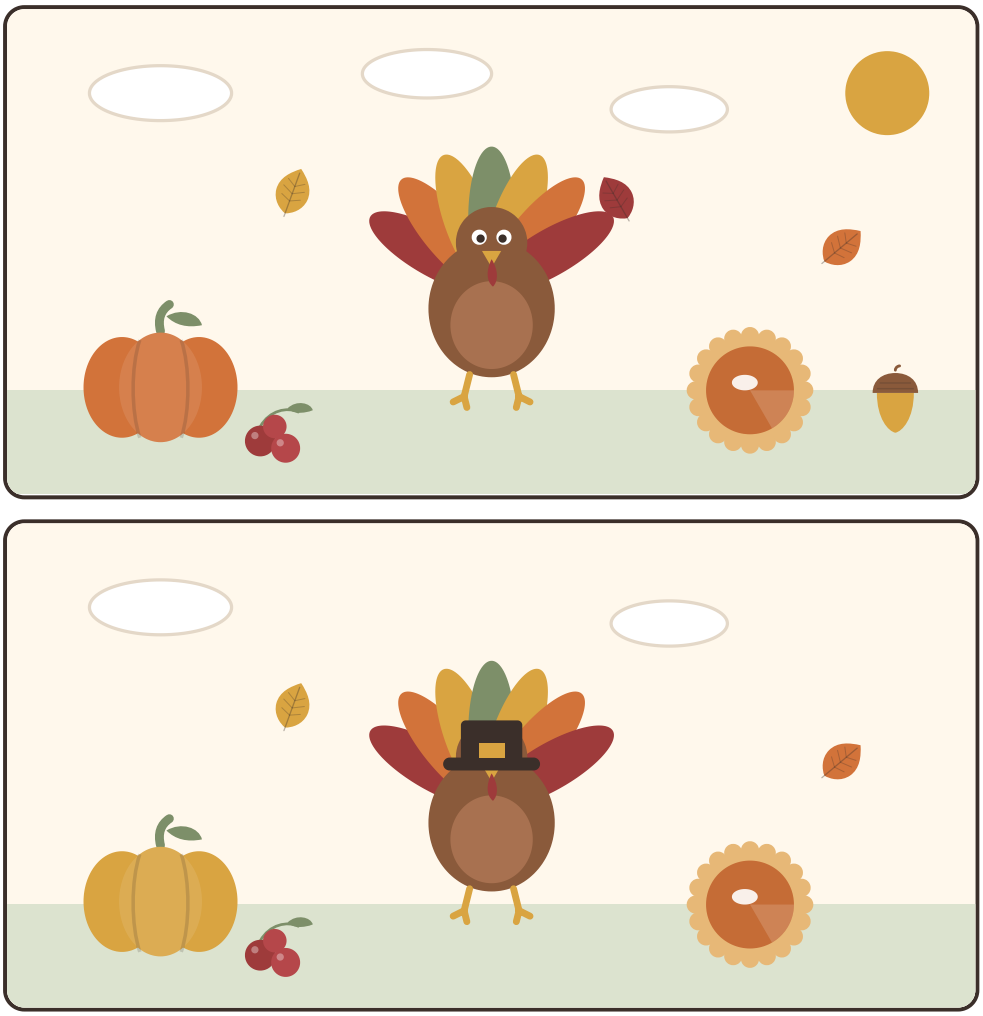
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6

PUZZLE 6 OF 8 · LOOKING

Spot the Difference

Gus took two photos of his harvest picnic, but someone changed the second one! Circle every difference in the bottom picture.



Number of differences I found: _____

TURKEY NUMBER CODE

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

☐ **Letter 6 of the pantry code.** Find your number in the Turkey number code. That letter goes in box 6.

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7

PUZZLE 7 OF 8 · DETECTIVE

Who Brought the Pie?

Four cousins each brought one dish to dinner. Gus wants to know who brought the pie, so he can sit next to them. Read the clues and fill in the grid: put × for "no" and ✓ for "yes".

1. Cole brought the rolls.
2. Ana did not bring the pie.
3. Ana did not bring the corn either.
4. Ben is not a baker: he did not bring the pie.

	Pie	Rolls	Corn	Salad
Ana				
Ben				
Uma				
Cole				

Tip: each cousin brought exactly one dish, and each dish was brought by exactly one cousin. When a row has three ×, the last square must be ✓.

The pie was brought by: _____

☐ **Letter 7 of the pantry code.** It's the first letter of that cousin's name. Write it in box 7.

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8

PUZZLE 8 OF 8 · PATTERNS

What Comes Next?

Gus lines things up in patterns while he waits for dinner. Find the missing number in each row.

A 2 4 6 ☐

B 10 9 8 ☐

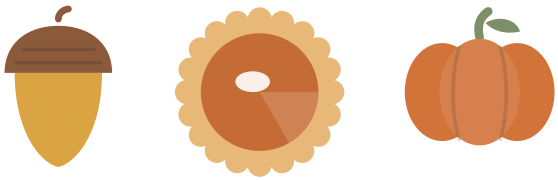
C 9 7 5 ☐

Now do Gus's sum: **A + B − C** = _____

TURKEY NUMBER CODE

A 1	**B** 2	**C** 3	**D** 4	**E** 5	**F** 6	**G** 7	**H** 8	**I** 9	**J** 10	**K** 11	**L** 12	**M** 13
N 14	**O** 15	**P** 16	**Q** 17	**R** 18	**S** 19	**T** 20	**U** 21	**V** 22	**W** 23	**X** 24	**Y** 25	**Z** 26

☐ **Letter 8 of the pantry code.** Find your answer in the Turkey number code. That letter goes in box 8.



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Hint cards

HOST KEEPS · CUT OUT

Hint for puzzle 1: Pie Math

Two pies make 8, so one pie is 4. Now use the pie to find the acorn.

Hint for puzzle 2: Secret Code

Match each picture to the key one at a time. The pumpkin is T and the acorn is E.

Hint for puzzle 3: Corn Maze

Try the maze backwards: start at the PANTRY and work toward START.

Hint for puzzle 4: Mixed-Up Kitchen

Every answer is something from Thanksgiving. The first word is TURKEY.

Hint for puzzle 5: Harvest Grid

Row 3 already has a pumpkin and a leaf, so the shaded square is a pie or an acorn. Column 1 already has an acorn.

Hint for puzzle 6: Spot the Difference

Check the sky, the turkey's head, the colors and the ground. There are 6 changes.

Hint for puzzle 7: Who Brought the Pie?

Cole brought the rolls, so he did not bring the pie. Neither Ana nor Ben did. Who is left?

Hint for puzzle 8: What Comes Next?

Row A counts up by 2. Row B counts down by 1. Row C counts down by 2.

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Envelope labels

CUT OUT · TAPE ON ENVELOPES

★ **START**
Open first

1 **Pie Math**
Puzzle 1 of 8

2 **Secret Code**
Puzzle 2 of 8

3 **Corn Maze**
Puzzle 3 of 8

4 **Mixed-Up Kitchen**
Puzzle 4 of 8

5 **Harvest Grid**
Puzzle 5 of 8

6 **Spot the Difference**
Puzzle 6 of 8

7 **Who Brought the Pie?**
Puzzle 7 of 8

8 **What Comes Next?**
Puzzle 8 of 8

♥ **FINALE**
Host only

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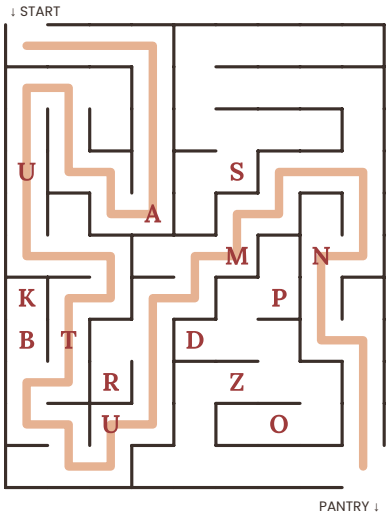
Answer key

HOST ONLY

1 = G Pie = 4, acorn = 2, leaf = 1. Pie + acorn + leaf = 7, and 7 = G.

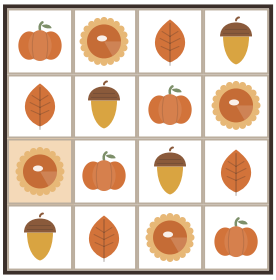
2 = R The note says LETTER TWO IS R.

3 = A The path collects A-U-T-U-M-N (AUTUMN). First letter: A.



4 = T TURKEY, OVEN, ACORN, STUFFING, THANKS. Shaded letters spell TOAST. First letter: T.

5 = E The shaded square (row 3, column 1) is the pie, and pie = E.



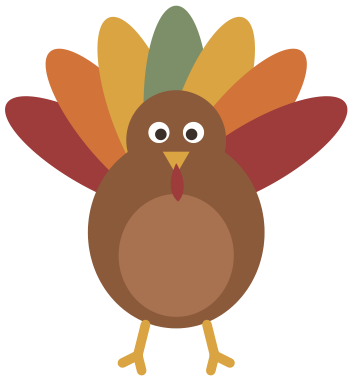
6 = F 6 differences: sun, middle cloud, red leaf and acorn are missing; the turkey wears a hat; the pumpkin is yellow. 6 = F.

7 = U Cole: rolls. Ana: not pie, not corn, so salad. Ben: not pie, so corn. Uma brought the pie: U.

8 = L A = 8, B = 7, C = 3. 8 + 7 - 3 = 12, and 12 = L.

The code word: G R A T E F U L

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OFFICIAL CERTIFICATE

Pantry Unlocked!

This certifies that

_____

name(s)

cracked all 8 of Gus's puzzles and saved Thanksgiving dessert.

Time: _____ Date: _____



Signed, Gus the Turkey